

OVERVIEW

Primal: The Awakening is a cooperative game for 1-4 players set in an epic fantasy world where humans are struggling to survive in an untamed wilderness. The game is played through a series of scenarios in which players take on the role of hunters battling monstrous creatures, as they embark on quests to defend humanity and uncover the mystery of *The Awakening*.

Players can set up standalone scenarios in **Expedition mode**, or instead play multiple scenarios that are linked together in one epic storyline in **Campaign mode**.

This *Rulebook* guides you through the learning process step by step, starting with the introductory scenario in the *Prologue* and then gradually exploring the Campaign and Expedition rules.

PROLOGUE

You start your adventure with the *Prologue* (page 3), which is a tutorial that teaches the basics of the gameplay and serves as the first scenario of the Campaign mode. This is your first step into the game.

CAMPAIGN MODE

Primal: The Awakening can be played as a series of multiple game sessions linked together by an overarching storyline.

The **Campaign mode** features:

- **A story to be discovered:** Choose your own path through the 30 different campaign quests and explore the lore of the game.
- **Crafting:** Craft your weapons and equipment using the materials you collect from slaying monsters.
- **Character progression:** Level up your character and customize your deck and playstyle.

The Campaign rules are covered in detail on page 37.

EXPEDITION MODE

The Expedition mode is designed for players who prefer playing quick, one-shot scenarios over a longer campaign game.

The **Expedition mode** features:

- **Standalone scenarios:** Choose from a wide variety of scenarios and set the complexity level as you wish.
- **Quick and easy setup:** Follow simple setup rules and start playing within minutes.
- **Customization options:** Build your own hunter or use one of the ready-to-play preconstructed decks.

The Expedition rules are covered in detail on page 65.

PROLOGUE

As you are walking toward the heart of the ancient Crimson Forest, warm, damp air rises from the ground. From afar, the scarlet foliage on the trees looks as if hundreds of little flames have been lit to heat the forest, like candles whose fiery tongues are no longer flickering but frozen in time. Silently, you push through the vegetation that meanders around the massive trunks of dark wood.

You are a newly formed squad, hand-picked by the Commander specially for this expedition. Dareon has been silent and brooding throughout the journey. You see him staring distrustfully at the forest with a look as hard as the blade he carries over his shoulders. In the vanguard, Mirah precedes the rest of the squad, striding gracefully and seemingly at ease, even in that unknown forest, as if nothing could escape her keen senses. Thoreg and Ljonar, a little further behind, are bringing up the rear of the squad. The former, in his shiny armor, has measured, confident strides; he has the experience and composure of a leader. The latter walks in line with the rest of the group, his towering shield hooked over his shoulder; he has the look of someone willing to bear any weight for the sake of the squad and his companions.

When you reach a crossroads in the undergrowth, you stop to consult the map: the missing seekers were exploring the valley's west of Woltyar. It is not the first time you have had to make your way through hostile territory like this. For as long as you have known the region, nature on Thyrea has always been indomitable and ferocious. Monstrous creatures lay claim to their territories, and ever since the people of Alborea first landed on the island, they have lived in acknowledgment of this natural hierarchy and taken refuge behind the walls of their fortified city. Only Seeker and Hunter squads like you can travel beyond the borders of Alborea, in search of resources and answers to the island's secrets.

You are now close to the point marked by the Commander, while the path under your feet seems to be trying its best to disappear among the tree roots and thorny red bushes along the trail. Suddenly, the unexpected happens: a deep roar in the distance breaks the silence of the march. All around you, cries and calls from animals and beasts ring out from all parts of the forest. As soon as you can, you find a gap in the tree canopy. Mirah, ahead of you all, stands transfixed as she stares at the

sky. Pinnacles of ash rise from Woltyar's caldera, forming a black cloud that expands across the sky. After having lain dormant for centuries, the great volcano of Thyrea has awakened!

The earth shakes violently. 'There's no time for fear' – that is what the Commander would always say during training. You run frantically, like predators mowing down roots and jumping over shrubs that hinder your passage. You find a small clearing from where you can observe the grim, terrifying spectacle. This event will change everything. You are sure of it, but you still cannot even begin to imagine just how much.

You notice Ljonar pointing his finger to the sky, squinting his eyes in an effort to see in the distance. From the curtain of ash, the silhouette of a creature with outstretched wings that has never been seen before emerges. Like a fiery lava bomb hurled from the mountain, a large, blood-red dragon can be seen flying at great speed over the expanse of scarlet foliage under which you have taken shelter. Its roar echoes through the valleys of Woltyar as if trying to unleash the wrath of the forest.

Just when you have got your hopes up that it has not caught the scent of you, the creature veers toward the clearing and swoops down on top of you. You leap out of the way, evading its impact just in time. You roll on the ground to the sharp sound of metal clunking as the dry grass of the clearing gets caught on your armor. You look up and the huge dragon is towering over you, angrily sniffing the air. You try to think quickly, scanning the nearby bushes and studying the battlefield. You shout over the beast's growl and frantically form a line to face it. Its hot veins pulsate and glow all along its muscular body. The fury of the volcano itself appears before you when the monster's huge jaws open violently to make way for the flash of flames ready to engulf you. But you, hunters, have no time for fear.

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- ◆ Read through the following sections. They will teach you the fundamental concepts of the game.
 - ◆ Set up the scenario according to the instructions on page 13.
 - ◆ Learn how to play through a scenario by reading the rules on page 17.

THE MONSTER

In *Primal: The Awakening*, the goal of the game in each scenario is to defeat the corresponding monster.

In the *Prologue* scenario, you will be fighting *Vyraxen*. This section features an overview of the components and key concepts relating to the monster.



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Vyraxen component overview

- Miniature:** Each monster is represented by a unique miniature.
- Monster board:** This features the following information:
 - Monster's name
 - Trophy icon
 - Monster element (large icon) and elemental weaknesses (smaller icons)
 - Health track
 - Behavior slots (x3)
- Behavior deck:** This is the main monster deck and determines its unique moves during combat.
- Stance deck:** Stance cards represent the different stages of the combat. As the monster suffers wounds, it progresses through its stances.
- Peril Deck:** These are special abilities that relate to the various stances.
- Objective card:** Players may wish to complete the objective to gain the bonuses and advantages described in the card text.
- Attrition deck:** These cards are used during the Attrition phase, in which players are at risk of suffering damage based on the cards they played during their turn.
- Struggle tokens:** The monster accumulates these tokens over the course of the game. The struggle tokens represent the intensifying rage of the monster.

PROLOGUE SETUP

To setup and play the *Prologue* scenario, you need only the components presented below. Any other components will be used in the Campaign and Expedition modes, so can be kept in the box for now.

Note: A full components list can be found on page 39.

GENERAL COMPONENTS



Combat board



4x Fire terrain token



1x Brush terrain token



1x Cyrycae terrain token



1x Baethanis terrain token



Round marker



Health marker



3x Trigger token



First player token



Aggro token



4x Threatened token



8x Deplete token



Vulnerable token



Stun token



Blind token



Confused token



4x KO token



Attrition deck (10x cards)



6x Struggle token



3x Bonus damage token (monster)



4x Strain token



25x Counter



5x Bonus +1/+3 damage token (weapon)



8x Stamina token



20x Damage token (1/5)



10x Damage token (10/50)



Vyraxen trophy icon



Vyraxen monster board



Vyraxen miniature

VYRAXEN COMPONENTS

You can identify *Vyraxen's* monster board and cards using the trophy icon and monster name.

While selecting cards, take only:

- Stance I, Stance II and Stance III cards that display the symbol  (aggression level) on the top left of the card. These are double-sided cards, so use the side with the correct symbol.
- Behavior cards that display the following aggression icons: , , or  (a total of 9 behavior cards).
- The peril and objective cards, using the side with the aggression icon .



3x Stance cards (I, II, III)



9x Behavior cards



3x Peril cards



Hit the Tail! objective card